



No Nexus Two?

Though Eric Schmidt said there will be no Nexus Two, he never said anything about a Nexus S. This is the rumoured successor to the "pure Google" N1 smartphone



Did you know?

Android's code contains 12 million lines of code

Digital Life



You might just brick your phone!

WARNING!!!

MUST READ: Installing a custom ROM on your phone does run the risk of potentially bricking it (i.e. your phone could become totally nonfunctional). Though the chances of something like that happening are probably lower than 99 to 1 (just keep your battery charged), we recommend you do your homework before attempting anything, unless you're a fan of very expensive paper weights.

only a few clicks away. No more are you required to hook your phone up to the desktop and drop down to the command line (us early adopters had it harder)!

What's more you ask? Well if you have not already figured it out then this would in effect also help you get rid of the custom UI (read: HTC Sense etc.) if you don't like it.

A Custom ROM is a modded version of the stock operating system and must not be confused with rooting. Rooting involves gaining superuser privileges but installing a custom ROM entails actually flashing the ROM (that's the hardware component that stores your operating system) and replacing what's already on there with what you wish. Installing a custom ROM requires rooting first, but rooting itself is a fairly simple task easily achieved by a few clicks without actually affecting your stock OS in any way.

There are a ton of custom ROMs available for Android and ROMs such as CyanogenMod and MoDaCo are examples of very popular ROMs that people

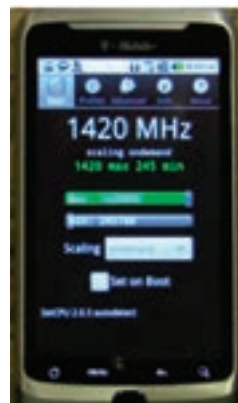
who want more out of their Android smartphones are adopting. They come with a whole host of added features such as AdFree (no more annoying ads!) and ADW Launcher preinstalled. Now we can't really afford to delve deep into the entire list of added features but what we do recommend is you go ahead and do a Google search for [YourPhoneModel] custom rom to explore and learn more about porting these wonderful innovations on to your Android handset.

ROM Manager is a great place to start if you want one app bundling your entire backup and custom ROM flashing experience. Here's a link to the wiki: <http://goo.gl/OSIez>.

The pitfalls

No OTA:

When FroYo launched, Google made the update available to the Nexus One device OTA (over the air). This means that the phone would download the update when you are in a WiFi zone and simply ask if you would like to update when ready. This would not be possible if you rooted your phone. Then again, it is of almost no conse-



SetCPU allows you to overclock

Outdated OS?

The open source advantage of Android is also its biggest problem right now. The fact that the code is made available to all and can be manipulated to your liking is being leveraged by phone manufacturers like Motorola, HTC and the rest in making their own customised user interfaces like the Sense UI designed to give you a "better user experience". In fact, what is happening is that everytime the company launches a new phone, the engineering team is busy porting their UI changes to the new model hence ignoring the other models who are left behind using an older version of Android. This "fragmentation" is only an issue because these stubborn manufacturers refuse to budge from the projects they have invested so much in hence leaving the consumer (You and me) using an older and slower version of Android with fewer features. Wake up and smell the coffee! As a consumer you ought to have the right to run the latest iteration of the OS on your phone and not lag behind like the rest of the cattle.

quence to other Android phone users since they have to wait for the phone manufacturer to send out the update!

Warranty voided: Gaining root access to your phone would void your phone warranty. There are again two sides to this coin – firstly, chances are that your limited warranty period has already expired and secondly, there is no shortage of phone repair shops in case something does go wrong with the phone. Check out Shekhar Kapoor's site here for a very interesting read: <http://goo.gl/cfcH6>.

Pricey paperweight: Every site you visit to read about installing a custom ROM will give you a large warning about the chances of bricking your device and though the chances are very very slim, it still is a possibility. Again, we recommend you just keep your battery charged.

It's your call

Now that all the information you need (enlightenment?) has been made available to you, we urge you to weigh your priorities and take a call (not make one). It's vital that you understand the horizons that open up to you when you choose to go down the rooting lane and the many perks that come with it. We leave you with a quote from J K Rowling - "Never trust anything that can think for itself if you can't see where it keeps its brain".